

CHENG ZENG

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Research Interests

Human-Computer Interaction; Spatial Computing and XR Interaction; Affective XR Environments; Cultural Heritage Informatics; Human-AI Co-Creation in Design; AI-Assisted Design Pedagogy

Education

Harvard University Graduate School of Design	2016.9–2018.5
Master in Architecture II	
Rhode Island School of Design	2012.6–2015.5
Bachelor of Architecture + Bachelor of Fine Arts	
University of Hong Kong	
Enrolled in Bachelor of Arts in Architectural Studies Program; transferred to RISD	2011.9–2012.6
Preparatory Studies in Engineering at Zhejiang University	2010.9–2011.7

Academic Experience

Shenzhen Technology University, School of Design and Innovation

- Lecturer, Department of Environmental Design 2023.12–present
- Teaching core design studios and technology courses in Environmental and New Media Art, including: Site and Spatial Design Studio, Advanced Digital Design Technologies, Creative Coding.
 - Supervising undergraduate theses exploring responsive environments and XR space design.
 - Developed practice-based studio projects addressing local community needs; led “Yuexi Plaza Landscape Revitalization” project which received Provincial Award for County Planning & Design Excellence (2024).
- Project Lead, University-funded Pedagogical Research Project 2025.1–present
- AI-Era Environmental Design Pedagogy: Linking Technology and Real-Site Practice to Enhance Student Engagement—received institutional funding to research and implement AI and Digital Technologies including AIGC, VR/AR and interactive media in Design Studios.

Research Projects and Publications

- **HeriTell**—A VR-based semantic authoring prototype that enables non-technical heritage experts to create component-anchored, LLM-structured annotations for architectural knowledge graphs.
Cheng Zeng, Qinrong Liu, and Pengcheng An. HeriTell: Supporting Interactive Documentation of Cultural Heritage Knowledge through Spatial Authoring. In *Proceedings of the Extended Abstracts of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '26)*.
- **Orchestrating Chaos**—An LLM-agent-augmented computational design workflow for reclaimed-material generative form exploration (Collaborative work during Tongji University Digital Futures Workshop 2025).

Awards and Exhibitions

Shenzhen & Hong Kong Bi-City Biennale of Urbanism/Architecture Exhibition 2025

- Asteroid-Linked Nexus—a Sci-Fi Space Dwelling Scene Concept; featured in Off-World Theater CAVE VR.
- Cloud Tower—an interactive VR experience inviting visitors to ascend an octagonal ancient tower, encounter East Asian urban density, and trace video-to-point-cloud visual transformation; featured in Paradox SCENE.

Third Prize, National Teaching Innovation Competition in Art & Design Education 2024 (“Future Designer 2024”, Nationwide Final Round)

- Site & Spatial Design Studio Empowering Rural Revitalization in Luhe County—team award; served as the main instructor guiding project design and presentation.
- Based on real sites in Luhe County; student design outcomes recognized by the local government.

Honorable Mention, Non-Architecture Unbuilt Project Award 2022

- Trace-S—a memorial park for Korea’s 416 ferry disaster (team award; contributed as main designer).

Top 3 Finalist, Urban Confluence Silicon Valley International Competition 2020

- The Nebula Tower—a landmark building and landscape design for San Jose (team award; contributed to early concept discussions and final design refinement).

Digital Design and Fabrication Exhibition, Harvard GSD 2018

- Spacerceramic—collaborative digitally-fabricated ceramic work, Harvard Ceramic Lab Exhibition.

Professional Experience

China Resources Land, Shenzhen Region 2021.4–2023.4

Senior Project Supervisor

- 2022 Educational Architecture Research Program—led a research initiative on educational environment design in Shenzhen, responsible for framework, survey data collection and presentation of findings.
- Chuangxing K-9 School New Campus—coordinated multi-stakeholder delivery with a public-oriented design management approach across all phases.

Sasaki Associates 2018.9–2020.8

Architectural Designer

- University of Lima Innovation Center (Peru)—Contributed from concept through construction documentation; project received SCUP Excellence in Architecture for a New Building Merit Award.
- Xinyang University Academic Center (China)—Actively participated on concept through schematic design for a 40,000 m² academic building; In charge of coordination with client and local consultant.

Skills

Computational Design & Programming: Python, Grasshopper, Processing, Arduino

Immersive Media & AI: Unity, TouchDesigner, Stable Diffusion, Reality Capture, AR/VR Prototyping

Modeling & Visualization: Rhino, Revit, Adobe Creative Suite, Physical Model Prototyping